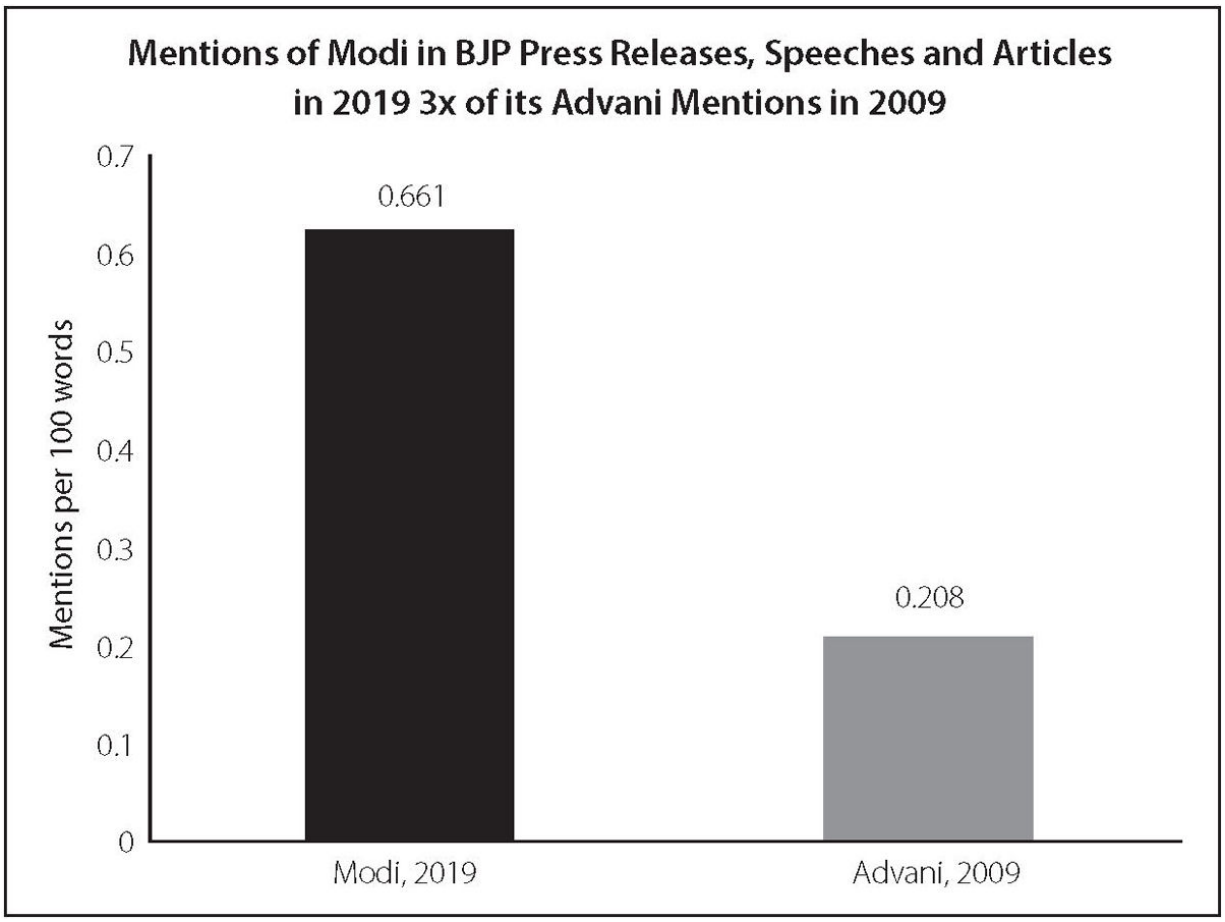


Source: Narad Index, Nalin Mehta and Rishabh Srivastava; for more details see Appendix 4/online on nalinmehta.in

Modi's personality has been even more crucial to the BJP than the last major leader around whom the party ran such personality-centric poll campaigns: Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee. Ahead of the 1998 general election, the party heralded Vajpayee with 'The Man India Awaits' advertisements. Vajpayee's persona, which morphed into 'The Man India Trusts' in BJP imagery by 1999, seemed to typify the party's identity from the mid-1990s to 2004.[11] However, we do not have comparable data for the Vajpayee years to pinpoint the Modi–Vajpayee difference for the party on the Index. Yet, the Advani–Modi statistical comparison does illustrate how Modi-centric the party has become during his years as prime minister. (Chapter 7 showcases how this reflects even more clearly in the BJP's digital media strategy.)